

UC Quants

what to change, and why.

The craft is already good. The token system, type scale, motion easing table and accessibility handling are better than most student-org sites ever get. **The problem is not styling — it is structure and content density.** Three root causes account for almost all of the flatness.

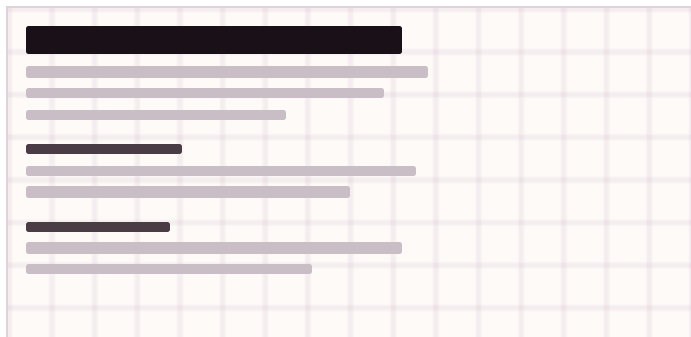
ROOT CAUSE 01

The 12-column grid is declared, then never used

`home.css` defines `.swiss-grid` as `repeat(12, 1fr)` — and then **11 separate rules set `grid-column: 1 / -1`**. Mission copy, role stack, proof head, proof lede: all full-bleed. The only real grid usage on the homepage is the hero. So the grid is wallpaper, not scaffolding.

Swiss design gets its energy from *asymmetry* — blocks pinned to different spans on different rows. Right now every row starts at column 1, so the eye never has a reason to move.

BEFORE — EVERYTHING SPANS 1 / -1



AFTER — DELIBERATE SPANS



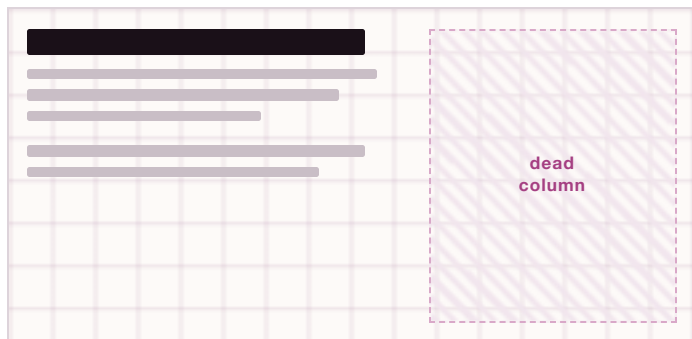
Fix: `.mission-head { grid-column: 1 / 6 } · .mission-body { grid-column: 7 / 12 }` · role label left, body right. Even a simple two-column split reads as designed rather than dumped.

ROOT CAUSE 02

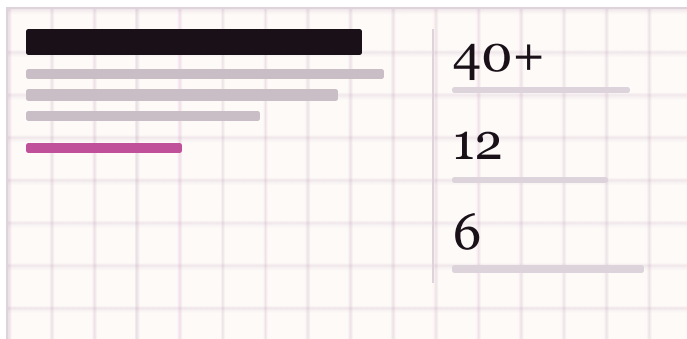
The right 40% of every screen below the hero is empty

Direct consequence of #1, plus `max-width: 66ch/78ch` on the prose. Copy stops around x=930 in a 1200px container, leaving a 270px+ band of nothing but grid lines all the way down. That doesn't read as airy whitespace — it reads as *unfinished*.

BEFORE — 270PX OF GRAPH PAPER



AFTER — RIGHT COLUMN DOES WORK



Fix: put a pull-quote, a stat pair, or a small chart in the right columns — or narrow `.home-wrap` to ~1040px so the copy fills its container. At 1200px with a 24px gutter your columns are only ~76px wide, too fine to structure anything anyway.

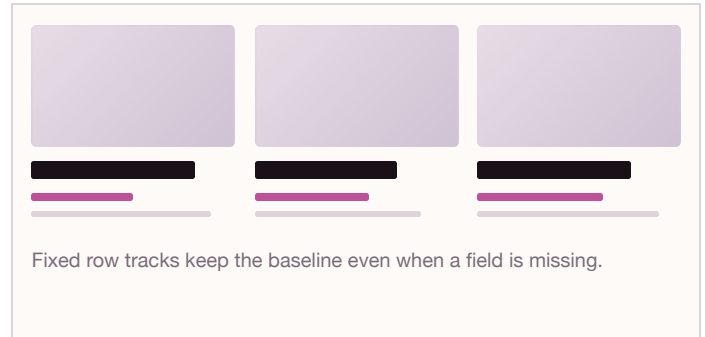
There is nothing to look at after the hero

One SVG wave, then ~1,700px of pure text, then three logos, then footer. **Zero photographs anywhere on the site** — including Meet the Team, the one page a visitor expects faces on. Seven names with no photos is the single biggest "underwhelming" signal you have.

BEFORE — NAMES ONLY (+ A REAL ALIGNMENT BUG)



AFTER — HEADSHOTS ON A COMMON TREATMENT



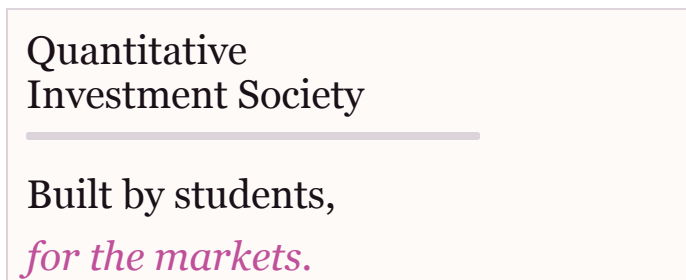
Fix, ranked: ① team headshots — even phone photos, cropped square and desaturated to one common treatment. ② one workshop/event photo on Home; real people in a room beats any SVG. ③ project thumbnails — equity curves, payoff diagrams, heatmaps. You're a quant club; you already have plots.

SECOND TIER

Your display type tier is defined and never used

`--fs-display` (`clamp(2.6rem, 6vw, 5rem)`) sits in `theme.css:59` and appears nowhere else. The hero `<h1>` and every `.section-title` both use `--fs-h1`, so the hero never dominates — everything is the same size, and that flattens the whole page.

BEFORE — ONE SIZE, NO HIERARCHY



AFTER — DISPLAY / H2 / LABEL LADDER

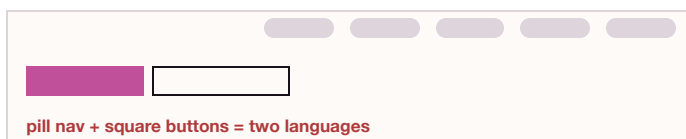


Fix: hero → `--fs-display`, `.section-title` → `--fs-h2`. One-line change, immediate hierarchy.

Dead class on your primary CTA, and two shape languages

`.nav-join` is applied in `index.html:57` but **has no matching CSS rule anywhere** — "Join Us" looks exactly like "Projects." Separately, nav links use `border-radius: 999px` while page buttons use `border-radius: 0`. Pick one; given the Swiss direction, squared is right.

BEFORE — CTA INDISTINGUISHABLE, MIXED RADII



AFTER — ONE LANGUAGE, CTA READS FIRST



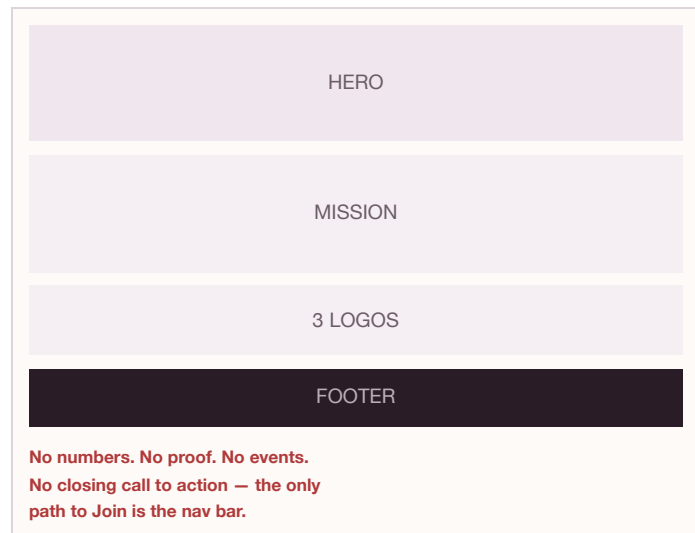
Smaller, contained fixes

ISSUE	WHAT'S WRONG	FIX
No-card rule read as no-structure	The three role blocks are visually identical to body copy. Cards aren't required, but Swiss replaces them with rules, numerals and scale jumps — you replaced them with nothing.	Add <code>01 / 02 / 03</code> numerals in the left columns plus a 1px top rule per row. Still no cards, but composed.
Grid background too loud	<code>opacity: .5</code> at 64px on every section, so empty space reads as graph paper rather than intent.	Drop to <code>~.28</code> ; add a <code>mask-image</code> fade below the hero so it's a hero treatment, not a global backdrop.
About intro line length	Runs the full 1200px — roughly 130 characters per line, about double the comfortable maximum.	Cap at <code>~70ch</code> , matching what you already did elsewhere.
Events page is 727px tall	Footer sits at the fold and the entire content is "No upcoming events." Anyone arriving from Instagram sees an empty room.	Backfill with past events and workshop recaps so the empty state is never the whole page.
Partner logos, three treatments	WSO is full-colour blue raster, City of Calgary is black raster, Vantedge is a letterspaced text wordmark.	Normalise all to ink <code>#1a1018</code> (or all grayscale) and match <i>optical</i> height, not box height.
Team row baseline breaks	Joseph Garas has no email, so his LinkedIn link rises ~29px and the row's baseline shears.	Reserve the slot with <code>min-height</code> , or give <code>.team-grid</code> fixed row tracks.

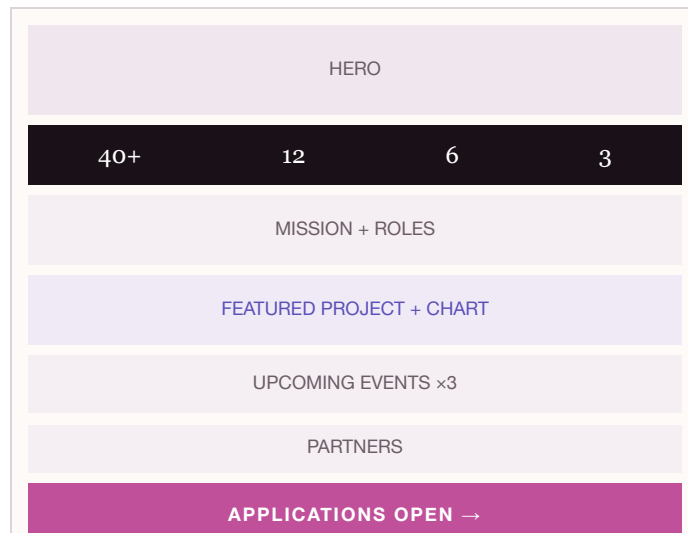
Home is missing the sections that make a club site land

Structurally your homepage is Hero → Mission → 3 logos → Footer. That isn't enough to impress regardless of how well it's styled.

BEFORE — 4 BLOCKS



AFTER — 8 BLOCKS, EACH EARNING ITS PLACE



The stats band is the highest impact-per-effort item on this whole list — four big numerals in `--fs-display` on a dark ground. It adds proof, breaks up the pale canvas, and uses the empty right columns from Root cause 02.

If you only do four things

SHIP FIRST SAME DAY WHEN YOU HAVE ASSETS

- **1. Break the full-width blocks onto real column spans.** Fixes the flatness *and* the dead right side in one pass. Contained to `home.css`, `about.css`.
- **2. Hero on `--fs-display`, section titles on `--fs-h2`.** Two lines of CSS. Instant hierarchy.
- **3. Add the stats band + closing CTA band to Home.** Dark grounds break the pale monotony and give the page a spine.
- **4. Team headshots.** Needs photos from the exec team, so start collecting now — but it's the biggest single perception jump available.

Items 1–3 are pure CSS/markup and could all land in one sitting. Item 4 is blocked only on assets.